

YOUR DIGITAL FOOTPRINT

What you leave behind,
and who picks it up

A complete week of teaching: reading, three activities, a discussion protocol, an exit ticket, vocabulary, answer keys, and a rubric. No prep, no accounts, no devices required.



GRADES 7-8



5 LESSONS



PRINT & GO



ANSWER KEY



NO DEVICES NEEDED



STATUTORY COVERAGE

Digital protection and online ethics §C1 • Digital footprint awareness and reputation management §V11 – Utah Code § 53E-4-208(1)(b).

Correlates to CSTA 2-IC-23.



TEACHER GUIDE

Module 1 — Your Digital Footprint

Students arrive believing two contradictory things: that nothing they post matters, and that deleting something makes it gone. This module takes both apart without moralizing.

Learning objectives

By the end of the module, students can:

- ▶ Distinguish between an **active** footprint (what you deliberately post) and a **passive** footprint (what is collected about you without an action on your part).
- ▶ Explain why deletion does not reliably remove information, using at least two mechanisms.
- ▶ Identify who realistically looks at a young person's footprint, and for what purpose.
- ▶ Evaluate a post against a four-question test and rewrite it to reduce avoidable risk.
- ▶ Justify a position on whether a person should be able to have old content removed.

TIMING — 5 × 45 MIN

Day 1 Do Now + reading (45)

Day 2 Activity 1 — Footprint Audit (45)

Day 3 Activity 2 — Reputation Timeline (45)

Day 4 Activity 3 + discussion protocol (45)

Day 5 Consolidation, vocabulary, exit ticket (45)

PREPARATION

Print the student pages (pp. 3–11). Nothing else. No devices are required — every source students need is printed in the module.

If you *do* have devices, the only optional extension is students searching their own name; read the caution below before allowing it.

The three misconceptions students bring

THEY BELIEVE	THE CORRECTION	WHERE IT GETS ADDRESSED
"If I delete it, it's gone."	Deletion removes your copy. It does not remove screenshots, reposts, archives, or backend records.	Reading, para. 4; Activity 2 event 4
"Nobody is looking at me. I'm thirteen."	Nobody is looking yet. The audit list is who looks in four to six years, which is the relevant timeframe.	Reading, para. 6; Activity 1
"Private account means private."	Private restricts who can see the post. It does not restrict what the platform collects, or what a follower does with a screenshot.	Reading, para. 3; Activity 1 Q5

How to open

Say this, or something close to it: *"I'm not going to tell you to be careful online. You've heard that since you were eight and it hasn't changed what anybody does. What we're going to do instead is work out exactly what already exists about a person, who can reach it, and what a smart person does with that knowledge. Then you decide what you want to do about your own."*

Framing this as competence rather than caution matters. Students who feel lectured stop engaging by day two, and the content of this module genuinely is a skill rather than a rule.

TWO CAUTIONS BEFORE YOU TEACH IT

Do not have students search each other. If you run the optional name-search extension, students search only themselves, and you tell them beforehand that they do not have to share what they find. Some students will find something upsetting — a parent's public post, an old account, an image they did not know existed.

Have your school's pathway ready. If a student discloses something distressing about content involving them, follow your school's existing safeguarding process. Do not promise confidentiality, and do not attempt to resolve it in the lesson.

If you only have one lesson

Run the Do Now (5 min), the reading paragraphs 1–4 and 6–8 (15 min), Activity 1 questions 1, 2 and 6 only (20 min), and the exit ticket (5 min). That covers §(vii) fully and §(i) partially. Skip Activity 2 and the discussion rather than rushing them — both depend on students having time to change their minds.

Where students commonly stall

STICKING POINT	WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT IN THE MOMENT
Activity 1 Q2 — they list three items but do not connect them	Ask: "If I only had the swim page, could I find her on a Wednesday? What does the newsletter add?" The word you are fishing for is <i>combine</i> .
Activity 3 — every rewrite is just deletion	Re-read the instruction aloud. Ask what the poster actually <i>wanted</i> , then ask whether they can still have it.
Discussion — the group agrees within two minutes	Hand them the second case (the news article naming a witness). Consensus rarely survives it.

WHAT'S IN THIS PACK

Teacher guide (p. 2) • Do Now (p. 3) • Student reading (pp. 4–5) • Activity 1 Footprint Audit (pp. 6–7) • Activity 2 Reputation Timeline (p. 8) • Activity 3 Rewrite the Post (p. 9) • Discussion protocol (p. 10) • Vocabulary (p. 11) • Exit ticket (p. 12) • Answer key (pp. 13–14) • Rubric, extension & home connection (p. 15)

STUDENT PAGE • DO NOW

Name _____

Date _____

Class _____

Do Now — Three guesses

Five minutes. Guess. You are not expected to know these yet, and you will not be marked on being right.

1. Think of one thing you have posted, sent, or uploaded in the last year. Without naming it, write down how many separate people or companies you think could still get to a copy of it today.

2. Name three different people or organizations who might one day look you up online. Be specific — “a person” is not an answer.

3. You delete a photo from an app. Write down everything you think happens to it. Then write down one thing you are *not sure* about.

4. Finish this sentence honestly: “The main reason I don’t worry about any of this is...”

KEEP THIS PAGE

You will come back to these four answers at the end of the module and mark them yourself. The point is not to be right now — it is to notice what changed. Question 4 in particular: by Friday you will either have a better reason, or the same one held more deliberately. Both are fine outcomes.

STUDENT READING • 1 OF 2

What a digital footprint actually is

1. Every time you use a connected device, you leave a trace. Some of those traces you make on purpose: a photo you upload, a comment you write, a video you post, a form you fill in. Together these are your **active footprint** — the part you chose.
2. Other traces get made whether you do anything or not. The pages you visit, the videos you watch and how long you watched before scrolling, the approximate place you were when you opened an app, the type of phone you own, the time of day you are most active. Nobody asked you to record any of that. It was recorded anyway. This is your **passive footprint**, and for most people it is far larger than the active one.

THE KEY DIFFERENCE

Your active footprint is what you *said*. Your passive footprint is what you *did*. Companies generally find the second one more useful, because people lie about the first one and nobody can lie about the second.

3. A common belief is that a private account solves this. It does not, and it is worth being precise about why. Setting an account to private changes *who among other users* can see what you post. It does not change what the company running the app collects, stores, or shares with partners. It also does not stop any one of your approved followers from taking a screenshot and sending it to somebody who is not approved. Private is a useful setting. It is not a shield.
 4. The second common belief is that deleting removes. When you delete a post, you remove *your copy* from public view. Consider what that does not touch:
 - ▶ **Screenshots.** Any viewer may already hold an image of it. You have no way to know and no way to recall it.
 - ▶ **Reposts and shares.** If somebody shared it, their copy is a separate object that your delete button does not reach.
 - ▶ **Archives.** Services exist whose entire purpose is to store snapshots of public web pages over time.
 - ▶ **Company records.** Deletion from your view and deletion from a company's systems are two different operations. Which one happens, and how quickly, depends on the company's policy and on the law where it operates.
- None of this means posting is dangerous. It means **deletion is a request, not an eraser**, and it is worth knowing that before you rely on it.
5. Your footprint is also not only made by you. A relative posts a photo of you at a family event. A club publishes a team list with your full name. A local paper runs a story about a school event. A friend tags you. Some of the most findable material about a young person was published by an adult, years ago, without being asked.

STUDENT READING • 2 OF 2

Who is actually looking

6. Right now, probably nobody. That is the honest answer, and it is why “be careful, people are watching” falls flat — students correctly notice it is not true today. The useful question is a different one: *who will look, and when?*

WHO	WHEN	WHAT THEY ARE TRYING TO FIND OUT
Admissions and scholarship committees	In 4–6 years	Whether you are who your application says you are. They are looking for contradictions, not perfection.
Employers	In 4–10 years	Risk. Would hiring you embarrass them in front of a customer?
Coaches, program leaders, hosts	Any time	Judgment and reliability, before handing you responsibility.
Other students	Now	Ammunition, usually during a conflict rather than out of general curiosity.
Strangers with bad intent	Now	Identifying details: your school, your routine, where you are on a Tuesday at four o'clock.
Automated systems	Constantly	Patterns, to decide what to show you next and what to charge you.

7. Notice that the last row is not a person. A large share of what reads your footprint is software, and software does not need a reason to be interested in you — it processes everyone by default.

THE FOUR-QUESTION TEST

Before you post something you are unsure about, run it through these four. You will use this test in Activity 3.

1. **Permanence** — if this still exists in five years, is that fine?
2. **Audience** — who could see this beyond the people I am imagining?
3. **Identifiability** — does this reveal where I am, where I go regularly, or who I am with?
4. **Context** — would this be understood the same way by someone who does not know me?

8. The fourth question is the one people underestimate. Most material that causes a problem later was not wrong when it was posted — it was a joke, an argument, or a moment among people who understood it. It becomes a problem when it is read by somebody who has no idea what came before it. **Context does not travel with content.**

9. One last idea. A footprint is not only a liability to be minimized — it is also something you can build deliberately. A student with a public portfolio of work, a coaching record, a volunteering history, or a well-kept project page has a footprint that answers the question “who is this person?” before anyone else gets to answer it for them. The goal of this module is not a smaller footprint. It is a footprint you chose.

ACTIVITY 1 · FOOTPRINT AUDIT

Name _____

Date _____

Class _____

Audit a stranger

Below is everything a person could find about Maya Chen, age 14, in about twenty minutes without any special tools. Read it, then answer the questions on the next page.

WHAT A SEARCH FOR “MAYA CHEN” TURNS UP		
SOURCE	POSTED BY	WHAT IT SHOWS
Regional swim club results page	The club	Full name, age group, times, and the name of the pool where she trains, with meet dates going back three years.
Local newspaper photo gallery	Newspaper	A captioned photo from a school science fair. Full name, school name, and the year.
A relative's public social post	Her aunt	Birthday photo, tagged with her first and last name, mentioning she has just turned fourteen.
Public gaming profile	Maya	Username <code>mayac_swims</code> , a bio reading “Lincoln MS · 8th · butterfly”, and a friends list that is visible.
Comment on a public video	Maya	An argument with another user from eleven months ago. Two comments are sarcastic and one is genuinely mean.
Old art-sharing account	Maya (age 11)	Drawings from three years ago, an abandoned bio, and the same username she still uses today.
School newsletter PDF	The school	Honor roll list including her full name, and a separate note naming her as a library monitor on Wednesdays.

BEFORE YOU START

Three of the seven items were posted by Maya. Four were posted by somebody else. That ratio is normal, and it is the first thing worth noticing.

ACTIVITY 1 · QUESTIONS

What did you find?

1. Sort the seven items into active and passive/other-posted. Write the source names in the correct column. /2

ACTIVE – MAYA POSTED IT	POSTED BY SOMEBODY ELSE

2. A stranger wants to know where Maya is on a weekday afternoon. Which three items, combined, would tell them? Name them and explain how they combine. /3

3. Which single item would matter most to a scholarship committee reading this in five years, and why? It may not be the one you first reach for. /2

4. The old art account uses the same username as her current profile. Explain the specific problem this creates. Use the word linkable in your answer. /2

5. Maya sets every account she controls to private tonight. List the items above that this does not affect, and state in one sentence why private accounts are a limited fix. /3

6. Maya asks you for advice. Give her three actions, ranked from most to least useful, and say what each one actually achieves. At least one of your three must be something other than deleting. /3

ACTIVITY 2 • REPUTATION TIMELINE

Name _____

Date _____

Class _____

Six years, one comment

Follow one item — the mean comment from Maya's argument — forward through time. At each point, decide what could still be done about it.



1. At which point in this timeline did Maya still have full control over the comment? Give the last moment, and explain what changed immediately after it. /2

2. The Month 11 deletion feels like the solution. Name two copies it does not reach, and explain why each is outside her control. /3

3. Rewrite the timeline for a version of Maya who handled it well. Change one point only — you may not change Day 0. State which point you changed, what she does instead, and what outcome that produces at Year 6. /3

4. A classmate says: “This is unrealistic. Nobody looks up a comment from six years ago.” Write the strongest version of their argument, then respond to it.

/2

Check your own thinking

Before you hand this in, mark each statement **T** or **F** and fix any you got wrong by going back to the reading. This is not marked.

T / F	STATEMENT	IF FALSE, WHY?
	Deleting a post removes every copy of it.	
	An archive stores a page as it looked at one moment in time.	
	The person who screenshots something needs your permission to keep it.	
	Acting early is usually worth more than acting forcefully.	
	A private account stops a company from collecting data about you.	
	Most of what exists online about a 14-year-old was posted by that 14-year-old.	
	Context travels with content when it is reshared.	

ACTIVITY 3 • REWRITE THE POST

Name _____

Date _____

Class _____

Run the four-question test

For each post: mark which of the four questions it fails (P, A, I, or C), then rewrite it so the person still gets to post what they wanted, with the avoidable risk removed. **Deleting it is not a rewrite.**

P Permanence

A Audience

I Identifiability

C Context

POST 1

“Home alone all week, parents are in Denver till Sunday anyone want to come over”

Fails: _____ Rewrite: _____

/2

POST 2

“mr okafor is literally the worst teacher at lincoln, genuinely how is he still employed”

Fails: _____ Rewrite: _____

/2

POST 3

A photo captioned “first day!! ” showing a student in front of a school sign, holding a schedule printout that is readable in the image.

Fails: _____ Rewrite: _____

/2

POST 4

“lol I basically didn't do any of the group project, thanks Priya ”

Fails: _____ Rewrite: _____

/2

POST 5

“every Tuesday and Thursday at Riverside courts 4pm if anyone wants to run games, we're always short”

Fails: _____ Rewrite:

/2

HARDER – ANSWER IF YOU FINISH EARLY

One of the five posts is defensible as written, depending on a detail the post does not tell us. Which one, what detail would decide it, and why does that detail change the answer?

Now write your own

Write a post you would genuinely want to make — about a win, a plan, a frustration, anything real. Then run your own four-question test on it, out loud on paper, and revise if you need to. Nobody else reads this unless you choose to share it.

My post:

Permanence — fine in five years? Audience — who else could see it? Identifiability — what does it reveal?
Context — how does it read cold?

Revised version (or write “no change needed” and say why):

DISCUSSION PROTOCOL

Should a fourteen-year-old be able to erase their past?

Structured discussion, 25 minutes. Everyone speaks. Nobody speaks twice before everyone has spoken once.

THE QUESTION

Some places give people a legal right to ask that old information about them be removed from search results. Others do not. **Should a person be able to require that something they posted as a child is removed once they are an adult — even if it was true, and even if somebody else wants to read it?**

Round 1 — Positions (8 min)

In groups of four. Each person is assigned a role and speaks for 90 seconds without interruption.

ROLE	YOUR JOB	START WITH
The person	Argue that people change and should not be permanently defined by something they did at thirteen.	"The strongest reason to allow removal is..."
The public	Argue that a record people can edit is not a record, and that some things should stay findable.	"If we allow this, the problem becomes..."
The platform	Argue from the practical side: who decides, who pays, and what happens at scale.	"In practice, this would require..."
The recorder	Do not argue. Note the strongest point each person makes, and one thing two of them agree on.	—

Round 2 — Pressure (10 min)

The recorder reads back the strongest point from each role. The group then tests all three against these cases:

- ▶ A person wants a photo removed that was posted by their parent when they were six.
- ▶ A person wants a news article removed that named them as a witness to a crime at fifteen.
- ▶ A person wants a mean comment removed that they wrote about a classmate who still remembers it.

Does your position hold in all three? If it does not, say so out loud. Changing your mind for a stated reason is the point of the exercise.

Round 3 — Landing (7 min)

Each group states one sentence beginning "*We think removal should be allowed when...*" and one beginning "*We think it should not be allowed when...*" The recorder writes both on the board. Then name what the disagreement between groups is actually about.

TEACHER NOTE

Do not resolve this. The productive outcome is students noticing the disagreement is not about facts — it is about whose interest wins when two reasonable interests conflict. That distinction returns in Module 4 (privacy) and Module 7 (AI ethics).

VOCABULARY

Module 1 terms

Definitions written for you, not copied from a dictionary. Fold the right column under and test yourself.

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Digital footprint	The complete set of traces you leave through using connected devices — everything you posted plus everything that was recorded about you.
Active footprint	The part you created on purpose: posts, comments, uploads, profiles, forms you filled in.
Passive footprint	The part collected without you doing anything deliberate: pages visited, watch time, approximate location, device type, time of day.
Persistence	The tendency of digital information to keep existing after you have stopped wanting it to.
Linkable	Able to be connected to something else about you. A reused username makes two separate accounts linkable to the same person.
Aggregation	Combining several harmless pieces of information until, together, they reveal something the pieces did not.
Context collapse	What happens when something written for one audience is read by a different one that has no idea what it was responding to.
Reputation management	Deliberately shaping what exists about you online, including by adding good material rather than only removing bad.
Archive	A stored snapshot of a web page as it appeared at a point in time, kept independently of the original site.
Identifiability	How easily a piece of content can be traced back to a specific real person, place, or routine.

THE ONE TO REMEMBER

Aggregation is the concept students most often miss and the one that does the most work later in the course. Your school name is harmless. Your training pool is harmless. “Library monitor Wednesdays” is harmless. Put all three together and you have a place and a time.

EXIT TICKET

Name _____

Date _____

Class _____

Module 1 exit ticket

Ten minutes. Answer in full sentences.

1. Give one example of an active footprint item and one example of a passive footprint item. Neither may be an example used in the reading. /2

2. Explain, in two sentences, why deleting a post does not reliably remove it. Name at least two different mechanisms. /2

3. Transfer. A friend says: “My account is private, so none of this applies to me.” Write your reply. Use the words aggregation and screenshot, and make it something a friend would actually listen to. /3

GO BACK TO YOUR DO NOW

Find the page from Day 1. Read your three guesses. Mark each one **closer than I thought**, **about right**, or **further than I thought**, and write one sentence about the one that surprised you most.

ANSWER KEY • 1 OF 2

Activities 1 and 2

Activity 1 — Footprint Audit (15 marks)

Q1 • /2

Active (Maya): gaming profile, comment on public video, old art-sharing account. **Other-posted:** swim club results, newspaper gallery, aunt's post, school newsletter. *1 mark for a fully correct active column, 1 for the other column. Do not penalize students who argue the swim results are semi-active because she chose to compete — accept with reasoning.*

Q2 • /3

Swim club page (which pool, plus meet schedule) + gaming bio ("Lincoln MS") + school newsletter (library monitor, Wednesdays). *1 mark per correct item; full marks only if the explanation shows the items **combine** — this is aggregation, and it is the point of the question. A student naming three items with no combination reasoning gets 2.*

Q3 • /2

Strongest answer: the mean comment, because it is the only item that speaks to character rather than activity, and committees are looking for contradictions with a self-presentation. *Accept the old art account for a well-argued answer about maturity or consistency. Do not accept the honor roll — reward students who notice that most of Maya's footprint is neutral or positive, which is itself a correct observation.*

Q4 • /2

The shared username makes the two accounts **linkable** — anyone who finds one can find the other, so content she posted at eleven is attached to her current identity without her ever connecting them herself. *1 mark for correct use of "linkable", 1 for identifying that this reaches backward in time to material she has forgotten about.*

Q5 • /3

Unaffected: swim club results, newspaper gallery, aunt's post, school newsletter — she does not control any of them. Also unaffected: existing screenshots of anything, and the archived copy. Limitation sentence should say that private restricts *which* users see new posts, not what is already out, what others posted, or what companies hold. *2 marks for the list, 1 for a precise limitation sentence. "Because people can screenshot" alone is 0.5 — push for the fuller distinction.*

Q6 • /3

Strong answers rank actions by what they actually achieve. Example: (1) change the username on the current profile and remove the school and grade from the bio — this breaks the link and cuts identifiability, and it is fully within her control; (2) ask her aunt to untag or restrict the birthday post — outside her control but usually granted if asked; (3) delete the mean comment — lowest value, since it is nearly a year old and copies may exist, but still worth doing. *Full marks require at least one non-deletion action and a stated effect for each. This question is where you find out whether the module landed.*

Activity 2 — Reputation Timeline (10 marks)**Q1 • /2**

The last moment of full control is **before posting on Day 0**. Within the first hour, two screenshots exist and control is gone permanently. Accept “the first few minutes” with reasoning. Do not accept Month 11.

Q2 • /3

Two of: the two screenshots (held by other people, on their devices), the Month 4 archived snapshot (a separate service she has no relationship with), any copy already reshared. 1 mark each, plus 1 for explaining that the common factor is that none of these copies are stored by the platform she deleted from.

Q3 • /3

Best answers change Day 2 or Month 4 rather than Month 11 — i.e. she notices early and acts before the archive sweep, or she responds to the argument publicly and reasonably so the screenshots capture something defensible. Reward students who realize that acting **earlier** beats acting **harder**. A student who changes Month 11 to “deletes faster” has missed it — 1 mark.

Q4 • /2

The strongest version of the classmate's argument is genuinely strong: reviewers are time-poor, most searches surface nothing, and the scenario requires an unlikely chain. A good response concedes this and shifts ground — the cost of the precaution is near zero, the cost of the rare bad outcome is high, and Maya cannot know in advance which case she is in. 1 mark for a fairly stated opposing argument, 1 for a response that engages it rather than restating the reading. Students who write a weak strawman get 0 for the first mark — say so.

ANSWER KEY • 2 OF 2

Activity 3 and exit ticket

Activity 3 — Rewrite the Post (10 marks)

POST	FAILS	WHY, AND WHAT A STRONG REWRITE DOES
1	A, I	Broadcasts an empty house and a specific return date to an audience wider than intended. Strong rewrite keeps the social invitation but removes the absence and the timeframe: “anyone around this week? looking for something to do”.
2	P, C	Names a real person and a real school in a way that persists and reads badly out of context. Strong rewrite keeps the frustration, drops the named target: “having a rough week with one class, any advice for dealing with a teacher you don't click with?”
3	I	The readable schedule gives a room-by-room location for every period. Strong rewrite is simply the same photo with the schedule out of frame or turned over. <i>Reward students who notice the caption is fine and the problem is entirely in the image.</i>
4	P, C	A joke that reads as an admission, naming a classmate who did the work. Strong rewrite flips it into credit: “Priya carried our group project, genuinely”. <i>This is the post students most often mark as harmless.</i>
5	I	A recurring time and a fixed public place — a routine, which is more useful to a stranger than a one-off. Strong rewrite moves the specifics to direct messages: “we run games at Riverside most weeks, message me for times”.

Marking: 1 mark for correct failure codes, 1 for a rewrite that preserves the poster's original purpose. A rewrite that simply removes the post scores 0 on the second mark — the skill being assessed is keeping what the person wanted while cutting what they did not intend.

THE “HARDER” QUESTION

Post 5 is defensible depending on whether the poster is an adult running an open community session at a public court, in which case advertising a fixed time is the entire purpose and is normal. The deciding detail is *who the poster is and whether the event is meant to be public*. This is the first appearance of a rule that recurs all course: risk is not a property of the content, it is a property of the content plus the person plus the audience.

Exit ticket (7 marks)

Q1 • /2

Any correct pair not drawn from the reading. Active: a review left on a store page, a username on a leaderboard, a comment on a class forum. Passive: how long they watched a video, which links they tapped, the fact that they opened an app at 2 a.m. *1 mark each. Reject examples lifted directly from the reading — the constraint is the assessment.*

Q2 • /2

Two mechanisms from: screenshots held by viewers, reshared copies owned by other accounts, independent archives, company-side retention. *1 mark per distinct mechanism. “It stays on the internet forever” is not a mechanism — 0.*

Q3 • /3

Look for three things: correct use of **aggregation** (harmless details combining into a location, routine, or identity), correct use of **screenshot** (private controls who sees new posts, not what an approved viewer does next), and a tone a friend would actually accept rather than a lecture. 1 mark each. The tone mark is not decoration — a technically correct answer that would make a friend defensive has not achieved the objective.

Common wrong answers, and what they tell you

IF A STUDENT WRITES...	WHAT HAS ACTUALLY GONE WRONG, AND THE FIX
"It stays on the internet forever"	They have the conclusion without a mechanism, which means they cannot apply it to a new case. Ask: "Stays where? On whose computer?" Push until they name a specific holder of a copy.
"Just don't post anything bad"	They have heard the rule and skipped the module. Point at Post 5 and the newspaper gallery — neither is "bad", and both carry risk. The skill is judgment, not abstinence.
"Delete it" as every recommendation	They think control is retroactive. Return to the Year 6 timeline and ask what deletion reaches. Then ask what she could have <i>added</i> instead.
"Her aunt shouldn't have posted that"	Correct but not useful — this is a judgment, not an action. Accept it, then ask what Maya does about it on Monday morning.
A rewrite that removes the post entirely	They have optimized for safety and lost the person's purpose. This is the most common Activity 3 error and worth addressing with the whole class rather than individually.

RUBRIC • EXTENSION • HOME CONNECTION

Marking and next steps

Module 1 rubric — for the audit and timeline together (out of 12)

CRITERION	EXEMPLARY (3)	PROFICIENT (2)	DEVELOPING (1)
Concept accuracy	Uses active, passive, aggregation, and linkable correctly and without prompting	Uses the terms correctly when the question supplies them	Terms used loosely or interchangeably
Aggregation reasoning	Shows how separate harmless items combine, and names what the combination reveals	Identifies correct items but treats them separately	Identifies items without connecting them
Practical judgment	Recommends actions ranked by real effect, including non-deletion options	Sensible actions, effects stated generally	Defaults to “delete it” for every problem
Reasoning under challenge	States the opposing argument fairly, then answers it on its own terms	Acknowledges the counter-argument, response is thin	Restates own position without engaging

Extension — for students who finish early

BUILD, DON'T SHRINK

Design a footprint you would *want* a stranger to find in five years. What three things would exist, who would have posted them, and what would they say about you? One page, no accounts required — this is a plan, not a task to actually publish.

THE PARENT PROBLEM

Four of Maya's seven items were posted by adults. Write a short, reasonable message she could send her aunt asking for the birthday post to be restricted. It has to be one an adult would actually say yes to.

Home connection

One question to ask someone at home: “Is there anything about me online that you posted? I'm not upset — we're studying this and I want to know what's out there.”

This one reliably produces a conversation, because the answer is usually yes and the adult has usually never thought about it. Tell students they are gathering information, not making an accusation — that framing is the difference between a useful conversation and an argument.

What comes next

Module 2 — *How the Internet Actually Works* — supplies the mechanism behind claims students have just taken on trust: why a copy exists in more than one place, who sits between a device and a server, and what “the company still has it” physically means. Students who ask “but *how* would somebody get it?” during Module 1 are asking a Module 2 question. Write those on the board and answer them next week.

That's Module 1. Eleven to go.

If this worked in your room, the full course runs the same structure across a semester: networks, cybersecurity, privacy, algorithms, AI literacy, misinformation, wellbeing, digital discourse, copyright, and a capstone.

DIGITAL SKILLS 7-8 — THE FULL COURSE

12 modules · roughly 180 pages · answer keys and rubrics throughout · the Course Blueprint & Standards Map included · print and digital.

A FAVOR, IF IT HELPED

This module is free. Ratings are what put it in front of the next teacher who has been handed a digital skills course and no materials. If it saved you a weekend, a review means a great deal.